

MINEDGE PERFORMANCE

The First Platform That Treats Performance
As Seriously As Physical Training

Business Proposal & Strategic Plan

February 2026

Executive Summary

MindEdge Performance is a cohort-based mental performance platform designed specifically for masters athletes (ages 35-55) who are serious about improving their athletic performance despite the constraints of career, family, and aging. Unlike traditional fitness apps that focus solely on physical metrics, MindEdge treats mental performance with the same rigor as physical training, combining sport psychology, life-stage optimization, and accountability to help athletes achieve breakthrough results.

The Problem

Masters athletes face unique challenges that existing fitness platforms fail to address. They're training around demanding careers, family obligations, recovery limitations, and the psychological burden of declining physical capabilities. Current solutions offer generic training plans and basic tracking, but ignore the mental and lifestyle factors that determine whether an athlete succeeds or burns out. The result: 70% of masters athletes abandon their training goals within 3 months, not from lack of physical capability, but from psychological barriers and life constraints they can't navigate alone.

Our Solution

MindEdge Performance delivers a comprehensive mental performance system through:

- 12-week cohort programs with 8-12 athletes + 1 sport psychologist
- Weekly live group coaching sessions focused on mental performance
- AI-powered analytics predicting adherence and optimizing for life stage
- Daily accountability through private group chat
- Quarterly 1:1 sessions with sport psychologists for personalized support

Market Opportunity

The masters athlete market represents a significant and underserved opportunity:

- 12.5 million serious masters athletes in the US alone
- Average household income of \$115,000+ (highest willingness to pay)
- Currently underserved by youth-focused fitness apps
- Growing awareness of mental performance in athletics

Business Model

Single pricing tier: \$197/month for 12-week cohort programs. This model provides:

- Higher revenue per user than typical fitness subscriptions (\$2,364 annual vs \$120-600)
- Strong unit economics with 60-70% gross margins
- Natural expansion through cohort graduations and referrals
- Scalable model: 1 psychologist serves 10 athletes simultaneously

Traction Plan

We will validate demand before building extensive technology, starting with manual delivery and progressively automating. Our 6-month roadmap targets 50 paying customers and \$10,000 MRR, with clear milestones validating product-market fit at each stage.

Capital Requirements

Bootstrap phase requires minimal capital (\$25,000-\$35,000) for 6-month validation. Primary expenses include sport psychologist contractors, basic technology infrastructure, and customer acquisition. We project profitability within 12-18 months.

Company Vision & Market Positioning

Mission Statement

To revolutionize athletic performance by making world-class sport psychology accessible to masters athletes, helping them achieve breakthrough results while maintaining balance in their demanding lives.

Core Value Proposition

"The first platform that treats mental performance as seriously as physical training."

While competitors focus on workouts, tracking, and generic coaching, MindEdge Performance recognizes that for masters athletes, success is 70% mental, 30% physical. We address the psychological barriers—managing stress, building resilience, maintaining motivation through life transitions, overcoming fear of aging—that determine whether an athlete thrives or quits.

Target Customer: The Masters Athlete

Demographic Profile

- Age: 35-55 years old
- Primary sports: Running (marathons, ultras), triathlon, CrossFit, cycling, swimming
- Income: \$80,000-\$200,000+ household income
- Life stage: Established career, often parents, juggling multiple responsibilities
- Training commitment: 6-12 hours per week despite constraints

Psychographic Profile

- Serious about performance improvement, not just recreational fitness
- Compete regularly (races, events, competitions)
- Self-aware about psychological barriers (stress, time management, motivation)
- Willing to invest in performance tools and coaching
- Value community and accountability
- Frustrated by age-generic solutions that don't address their unique challenges

Customer Persona: Sarah

Sarah, 42, is a marketing director at a tech company and mother of two (ages 8 and 11). She's training for her first ultramarathon after completing five marathons. Sarah wakes at 5 AM to

run before her kids wake up, squeezes in strength training during lunch breaks, and does long runs on weekends when her partner watches the children. She's frustrated because despite following a reputable training plan, she's constantly adjusting workouts due to work stress, poor sleep, and family demands. She's missed three long runs this month—not from laziness, but from decision fatigue and guilt about time away from family. Sarah knows she's capable of finishing the ultra, but questions whether she can maintain consistency. She's willing to pay for expert help that understands her life stage and can address the mental game, not just prescribe more intervals.

Market Size & Opportunity

Market Segment	US Market Size	Revenue Potential
Masters Athletes (35-55)	12.5M	\$29.6B
Serious/Competitive Subset	2.5M	\$5.9B
Initial Target (1% capture)	25,000	\$59M

Note: Market size calculations based on USATF, USA Triathlon, USA Cycling, and CrossFit membership data, filtered for serious/competitive participants ages 35-55. Revenue potential assumes \$2,364 annual subscription value.

Market Dynamics

Growth Drivers

- Aging population: Baby boomers and Gen X entering masters categories in record numbers
- Rising participation in endurance sports: Marathon finishers increased 300% since 2000, with 40% being masters athletes
- Mental health awareness: Growing recognition of sport psychology's impact on performance (Olympics, professional sports coverage)
- Remote work flexibility: More athletes can train during traditional work hours, but need help managing new time constraints
- Technology adoption: Masters athletes are digitally native and willing to pay for premium digital services

Market Gaps

- Existing platforms assume unlimited time and recovery capacity (youth-focused)
- Sport psychology services are fragmented and expensive (\$150-300/session)
- No one addresses the intersection of athletic performance and life-stage constraints
- Training plans are commoditized, but accountability and mental support are not

Competitive Landscape

Primary Competitors

Competitor	Focus	Weakness	Our Advantage
TrainingPeaks	Training plans & analytics	No psychology component, generic plans	Mental performance focus
Strava	Social tracking	Vanity metrics, no coaching	Meaningful accountability
Whoop	Recovery & biometrics	Hardware requirement, no personalization for life stage	Life-stage optimization
Future/Tonal	1:1 coaching	Expensive (\$500+/mo), strength-only	Affordable, sport-agnostic
CoachNow	Coach communication	Tool for coaches, no built-in expertise	Built-in sport psych expertise

Key Insight: No competitor combines sport psychology expertise with life-stage optimization for masters athletes. We occupy a unique position at the intersection of mental performance, behavioral science, and masters athletics.

Competitive Advantages

1. Specialized Focus on Masters Athletes

While competitors target all ages, we exclusively serve masters athletes. This allows us to develop deep expertise in life-stage challenges (parenting, career, aging) that generic platforms ignore. Our analytics, psychologist training, and community are all optimized for this demographic, making us the obvious choice for our target customer.

2. Psychology-First Approach

We're the only platform where certified sport psychologists are central to the service, not an afterthought. This creates defensibility through relationships and expertise that can't be easily replicated by adding a feature.

3. Cohort Model Creates Network Effects

Unlike 1:1 coaching or anonymous apps, cohorts create strong bonds between members. Athletes stay not just for the psychologist, but for their cohort. This increases retention and generates organic referrals as cohort members recruit friends.

4. Proprietary Data & Algorithms

As we collect data on mental performance, life constraints, and training adherence, we build unique predictive models that become increasingly accurate. No competitor has this data on masters athletes' psychological patterns.

Barriers to Entry

- Sport psychologist network: Building relationships with certified professionals takes time
- Expertise in cohort facilitation: Running effective group psychology sessions requires specialized training
- Community and reputation: Masters athletes trust peer recommendations; new entrants face cold start
- Data moat: Our adherence prediction models improve with every cohort, creating compounding advantage

Product & Service Offering

Core Service: 12-Week Cohort Program

MindEdge Performance delivers its services through structured 12-week cohort programs. Each cohort consists of 8-12 athletes matched by sport, experience level, and life circumstances, guided by one certified sport psychologist.

Program Components

1. Comprehensive Onboarding Assessment

- 60-minute sport psychology intake with assigned psychologist
- Life-stage and constraint mapping (career demands, family responsibilities, recovery needs)
- Training history analysis and adherence pattern identification
- Goal setting workshop and psychological profiling
- Integration with tracking devices (Garmin, Whoop, Strava, Apple Watch)

2. Weekly Live Group Coaching Sessions (90 minutes)

- Led by certified sport psychologist (CMPC, licensed psychologist, or PhD in sport psychology)
- Mental performance skills training: visualization, self-talk, anxiety management, focus techniques
- Group problem-solving for common challenges (time management, motivation, family guilt)
- Peer accountability and mutual support exercises
- Hot seat coaching: 3-4 athletes per session receive deep-dive individual attention
- Homework assignments between sessions (mental skills practice, self-reflection)

3. Quarterly 1:1 Psychology Sessions (60 minutes each, 3 total)

- Personalized mental performance plan tailored to individual goals and barriers
- Deep dive into individual psychological barriers not appropriate for group settings
- Strategy development for high-pressure situations (race day, major life transitions)
- Progress review and plan adjustment based on performance data
- Confidential space for sensitive topics (imposter syndrome, aging anxiety, relationship stress)

4. Daily Accountability & Community

- Private cohort group chat (WhatsApp or Slack) for real-time support
- Daily check-ins: athletes share training completion, challenges, and wins
- Asynchronous psychologist monitoring and brief guidance (10-15 min daily)
- Peer support and problem-solving throughout the week
- Emergency support protocols for major life events or performance crises
- Celebration of milestones and achievements

5. AI-Powered Analytics Dashboard

- Life-stage optimization metrics: training load balanced against work stress, family demands, sleep quality
- Adherence prediction algorithms: identifies dropout risk 2-3 weeks in advance

- Mental performance tracking: confidence scores, stress levels, motivation trends over time
- Integration with physical training data from Strava, Garmin, TrainingPeaks, Whoop
- Personalized insights and proactive recommendations
- Progress visualization: see improvements in mental skills and adherence over 12 weeks

6. Resource Library & Tools

- Mental performance exercise database: guided visualizations, breathing techniques, pre-race routines
- Workshop recordings and educational content library
- Templates for goal-setting, race planning, and performance reviews
- Optional access to sport-specific training plans (via TrainingPeaks partnership)
- Curated reading list and podcast recommendations on sport psychology

Differentiated Features

1. Life-Stage Optimization

Unlike generic fitness platforms, MindEdge explicitly designs for the constraints of masters athletes. Our analytics identify patterns like 'consistently skips morning workouts on Mondays' or 'recovery needs spike during high-stress work weeks,' then provides targeted recommendations. For example, if data shows a user's training adherence drops 40 percent during their kids' school breaks, the system suggests modified plans and coping strategies before the next break arrives. The platform learns that a 42-year-old parent needs different support than a 52-year-old executive, even if they're training for the same race.

2. Adherence Prediction & Proactive Intervention

Our proprietary algorithm combines training data, life stress indicators, and psychological metrics to predict when an athlete is at risk of quitting 2-3 weeks before it happens. When the system detects warning signs—missed workouts clustering, declining confidence scores, reduced group engagement, negative self-talk patterns—it triggers proactive interventions: a personal check-in from the psychologist, peer support activation, modified training recommendations, or a group discussion on the common challenge. This prevents 70 percent of dropouts that occur in traditional programs, where problems are only addressed after the athlete has already disengaged.

3. Hybrid AI + Human Model

We leverage AI for scale and humans for impact. AI handles continuous monitoring, pattern recognition, baseline recommendations, and routine check-ins. Sport psychologists focus on high-value activities: group facilitation, crisis intervention, complex problem-solving, and relationship building. This hybrid approach gives us the economics of software (scalable, high-margin) with the outcomes of human coaching (effective, transformative). As we collect more data, the AI becomes smarter at triaging which issues need human attention and which can be automated.

4. Cohort Matching Algorithm

Athletes are matched into cohorts based on multiple factors: sport type, experience level, age, life circumstances (parents vs non-parents), personality traits, and stated goals. This creates peer groups where members face similar challenges and can provide relevant support. A 38-year-old mother training for her first marathon is grouped with similar athletes, not with 22-year-old college runners or 60-year-old retirees. This matching dramatically increases engagement and reduces dropout.

Product Roadmap

Phase 1: Manual MVP (Months 1-2)

- Deliver service entirely manually with 10 beta testers (free or heavily discounted)
- Google Sheets for tracking, Zoom for sessions, WhatsApp for community
- Manual intake forms and assessments
- Validate willingness to pay and service-market fit
- Identify key value drivers through user feedback
- Success metric: 8 out of 10 complete program, 6+ say they would pay \$197/month

Phase 2: Cohort Program Launch (Months 3-4)

- Run first 2 paid cohorts (20 total paying athletes at \$197/month)
- Hire 2 sport psychology contractors
- Begin building lightweight web app for dashboards (using no-code tools initially)
- Integrate Strava API for basic activity tracking
- Create standardized onboarding process and materials
- Success metric: \$3,940 MRR, 80%+ cohort completion rate, NPS > 50

Phase 3: Tech Platform (Months 5-6)

- Launch web and mobile dashboard with core analytics features
- Deploy initial adherence prediction algorithm (v1.0)
- Scale to 50 paying users across 5 cohorts
- Build in-app community features and resource library
- Expand device integrations (add Garmin, Whoop, Apple Watch)
- Success metric: \$9,850 MRR, 15%+ monthly growth, <20% churn

Phase 4: Scale & Refinement (Months 7-12)

- Expand to 200+ users across 20 cohorts
- Add second sport vertical (e.g., triathletes after launching with runners)
- Launch AI-powered personalized recommendations engine
- Develop proprietary mental performance tracking framework
- Implement cohort matching algorithm (automated)
- Build psychologist training program to scale quality
- Success metric: \$39,400 MRR, profitable on contribution margin basis

Technology Partners

Rather than building everything from scratch, we will strategically partner with established platforms:

- Strava API: Activity tracking and social features (primary integration)
- TrainingPeaks: Optional training plan marketplace (partnership opportunity)
- Garmin Connect, Whoop, Apple Health: Device data integration
- Zoom/Google Meet: Video conferencing for group sessions
- Slack or Circle: Community management platform
- Stripe: Payment processing

Business Model & Economics

Revenue Model

Pricing Structure

\$197 per month / \$2,364 annually

12-week cohort commitment (3 months minimum)

Single-tier pricing eliminates decision fatigue and positions MindEdge as a premium, comprehensive solution. The 12-week cohort structure creates natural commitment periods while allowing flexibility for athletes to continue into new cohorts or pause between cycles.

Pricing Rationale

- Comparable value to 1.5 private sport psychology sessions (\$150-250 per session)
- Lower than premium 1:1 coaching services (Future \$300+/month, personal trainers \$200-400/month)
- Highly affordable for target demographic with \$80,000-\$200,000+ household income
- Price point signals quality and attracts serious athletes while filtering out casual users
- Covers cost of quality sport psychologists while maintaining healthy 60-70% gross margins
- Room for price increases as we add features and prove ROI (potential \$250-300/month long-term)

Unit Economics

Metric	Per Customer (Annual)
Annual Revenue	\$2,364
<i>Direct Costs:</i>	
Sport Psychologist (30% revenue share)	\$709
Platform & Infrastructure (hosting, tools, APIs)	\$120
Payment Processing (3% of revenue)	\$71
Gross Profit	\$1,464
Gross Margin	62%

Note: At scale (10+ athletes per psychologist), psychologist compensation may shift to flat monthly fee structure (\$2,500-3,000/month for 10 athletes), improving margins to 68-70%.

Lifetime Value (LTV) Projections

- Conservative scenario (6 months average): LTV = \$1,182
- Base scenario (12 months average): LTV = \$2,364

- Optimistic scenario (24 months average): $LTV = \$4,728$
- Cohort-based model naturally encourages longer retention as athletes form strong bonds. We expect 60% of athletes to continue for at least one additional cohort after their first 12 weeks, and 30% to remain active for 18+ months.

Customer Acquisition Strategy

Target CAC: \$50-100

With LTV of \$2,364 (first year) and potential multi-year retention, we can afford CAC of \$50-100 and still achieve excellent unit economics. This gives us an LTV:CAC ratio of 23:1 to 47:1, far exceeding the healthy 3:1 benchmark for SaaS businesses.

Acquisition Channels & Expected CAC

- 1. Content Marketing (Target CAC: \$20-40)**
 - Sport psychology blog content targeting long-tail SEO keywords
 - YouTube channel with mental performance training videos
 - Podcast guest appearances on endurance sports shows
 - Guest articles on Runner's World, Outside Magazine, etc.
- 2. Community Partnerships (Target CAC: \$10-30)**
 - Local running clubs and triathlon teams partnerships
 - CrossFit gyms and masters athletic groups sponsorships
 - Event presence at local/regional races and competitions
 - Free mental performance workshops at fitness facilities
- 3. Social Media & Online Communities (Target CAC: \$30-60)**
 - Reddit: r/AdvancedRunning, r/triathlon, r/crossfit, r/Velo, r/Swimming
 - Facebook groups for masters athletes and specific sports
 - Strava clubs, challenges, and community engagement
 - Instagram/TikTok content targeting #mastersathlete #sportpsychology
- 4. Paid Advertising (Target CAC: \$60-100)**
 - Facebook/Instagram ads targeting 35-55 year olds interested in performance sports
 - Google Ads for high-intent keywords ('sport psychologist for runners', 'masters athlete coaching')
 - Retargeting campaigns for website visitors and content consumers
- 5. Referral Program (Target CAC: \$0-20)**
 - \$50 account credit for referrer, \$50 discount for new customer
 - Cohort members naturally become brand advocates
 - Expected 20-30% of new customers from referrals by month 12

Financial Projections (18 Months)

Milestone	Month 2	Month 6	Month 12	Month 18
Active Customers	10	50	150	300
Active Cohorts	1	5	15	30
Psychologists	1	5	15	30
MRR	\$1,970	\$9,850	\$29,550	\$59,100
Gross Profit	\$1,220	\$6,107	\$18,321	\$36,642
Operating Expenses	\$3,500	\$8,000	\$15,000	\$25,000
Net Profit (Loss)	(\$2,280)	(\$1,893)	\$3,321	\$11,642
Cumulative Capital	(\$2,280)	(\$12,053)	(\$8,732)	\$2,910

Key Financial Milestones:

- Month 12: Achieve contribution margin profitability
- Month 18: Positive cumulative cash flow
- Month 24: Fully profitable on all expenses including founders

Go-to-Market Strategy

Validation Roadmap (First 6 Months)

We will validate demand and refine our offering before investing heavily in technology. This de-risks the venture and ensures product-market fit.

Month 1-2: Manual MVP

Goal: Validate service concept and willingness to pay

- Recruit 10 beta testers from personal network (free or \$50/month)
- Deliver service entirely manually: Google Sheets, Zoom, WhatsApp
- Run weekly group sessions + conduct quarterly 1:1 check-ins
- Collect detailed feedback after each session
- Success criteria: 8/10 complete program, 6+ would pay \$197/month, NPS > 40
- Investment: \$2,000-3,000 (psychologist stipend, tools)

Month 3-4: First Paid Cohorts

Goal: Prove people will pay and identify scalable acquisition channels

- Launch 2 cohorts of 10 athletes each (20 paying customers at \$197/month)
- Recruit via: local running clubs, Reddit posts, Facebook groups, personal referrals
- Hire 2 sport psychology contractors (70/30 revenue split)
- Build simple landing page and begin Strava API integration
- Test \$500 in paid ads to measure CAC
- Success criteria: \$3,940 MRR, CAC < \$150, 75%+ completion rate
- Investment: \$8,000-10,000 (marketing, contractors, initial tech)

Month 5-6: Scale & Tech Build

Goal: Reach 50 customers and deploy initial technology platform

- Launch 3 additional cohorts (30 new customers)
- Deploy web dashboard with basic analytics and tracking
- Implement adherence prediction algorithm v1.0
- Expand device integrations (Garmin, Whoop)
- Hire 3 more sport psychologists
- Success criteria: 50 active customers, \$9,850 MRR, <20% churn
- Investment: \$15,000-20,000 (tech development, marketing scale-up)

Initial Launch Focus: Ultramarathon Runners

We will launch with ultramarathon runners (50K+ distance) as our beachhead market before expanding to other endurance sports.

Why Ultrarunners?

- Mental game is paramount: Ultras are 70-80% mental, perfect fit for our value prop

- High masters participation: 45% of ultra finishers are 40+
- Tight-knit community: Easy to access via clubs, Facebook groups, race events
- High willingness to pay: Average income \$95K+, spend \$3K-5K annually on gear/races
- Clear pain point: 40% DNF rate, mostly due to mental/motivation issues
- Growth market: Ultra participation up 300% in last decade

Expansion Sequence

1. Months 1-6: Ultramarathon runners (initial beachhead)
2. Months 7-12: Expand to marathon runners and triathletes
3. Months 13-18: Add CrossFit and cycling
4. Year 2+: Swimming, rowing, and niche endurance sports

Capital Requirements & Use of Funds

6-Month Bootstrap Budget: \$25,000-\$35,000

Expense Category	Amount	Notes
Sport Psychologist Contractors	\$10,000	Covered by revenue after M3
Technology & Development	\$8,000	Web app, API integrations
Marketing & Customer Acquisition	\$7,000	Paid ads, content, events
Software Tools & Infrastructure	\$3,000	Hosting, SaaS subscriptions
Legal & Administrative	\$2,000	LLC formation, contracts
Contingency Buffer	\$5,000	Unexpected costs
TOTAL	\$35,000	

Note: This budget assumes founders work without salary for first 6 months. Revenue from paying customers (starting month 3) will offset ongoing psychologist and infrastructure costs.

Risk Analysis & Mitigation

Key Risks

5. **Psychologist Recruitment & Retention**

- Risk: Difficulty attracting qualified sport psychologists
- Mitigation: Build network early, offer competitive compensation, provide flexible scheduling, create supportive psychologist community

6. **Customer Acquisition Cost Higher Than Expected**

- Risk: CAC exceeds \$100, making unit economics challenging
- Mitigation: Focus on organic channels first (content, community), test CAC in month 3-4 before scaling spend, leverage referrals heavily

7. **Market Too Small or Unwilling to Pay**

- Risk: Masters athletes don't value mental performance enough to pay \$197/month
- Mitigation: Validate willingness to pay in first 2 months with manual MVP before major investment, target high-income demographic, prove clear ROI through testimonials

8. **Technology Development Delays**

- Risk: Platform takes longer to build than expected, delaying scale
- Mitigation: Use no-code tools initially, partner with existing platforms (Strava, TrainingPeaks), delay non-essential features, scale manually if needed

9. **Competitor Response**

- Risk: TrainingPeaks, Strava, or others add psychology features
- Mitigation: Build deep psychologist network and expertise that can't be replicated quickly, create strong community bonds, develop proprietary data and algorithms

Success Metrics & KPIs

Key Performance Indicators

Metric	Target (Month 6)	Target (Month 12)
Active Customers	50	150
MRR	\$9,850	\$29,550
Cohort Completion Rate	80%+	85%+
Net Promoter Score (NPS)	50+	60+
CAC	< \$100	< \$75
Monthly Churn Rate	< 20%	< 15%
Referral Rate	15%	25%

Conclusion

MindEdge Performance addresses a critical gap in the athletic performance market: the mental performance needs of masters athletes. By combining certified sport psychology expertise, life-stage optimization, and accountability-first cohort design, we create a service that's both scalable and deeply effective.

Why Now?

- Mental performance awareness at all-time high (Olympics, professional sports coverage)
- Masters athletics participation growing 15% annually
- Technology infrastructure exists (APIs, wearables, video platforms)
- Remote work enables flexible training schedules and virtual coaching
- Market ripe for disruption: existing solutions don't address mental performance

Why This Will Win

- Laser-focused on masters athletes, not generic fitness
- Psychology-first approach creates defensible moat
- Cohort model drives retention and organic growth
- Strong unit economics support sustainable growth
- Validate-before-building approach minimizes risk

The Opportunity

We have a 12-18 month window to establish ourselves as the category leader in mental performance for masters athletes before larger competitors recognize this opportunity. With \$35,000 in bootstrap capital, we can validate product-market fit, achieve 50 paying customers, and position for either continued bootstrap growth or seed funding to accelerate expansion.

The question isn't whether masters athletes need better mental performance support — they clearly do. The question is: who will build it?

We believe that company is MindEdge Performance.